



Park Board General Manager's Report

April 27, 2026

The following report is intended to provide an overview and update on recent and upcoming activities within the Park Board.

Memorial West Park Improvements

At Memorial West Park, the hydraulic irrigation system installed in 1980 had reached end of life and was no longer operational. This system was one of nine remaining hydraulic installations across the parks network prioritized for replacement. A complete irrigation system replacement has now been completed on this heavily used Class B-1, sand based, multi-use sports field. System design and construction were delivered internally by the Park Board Irrigation Team in collaboration with Park Operations staff.

Over a three-week construction period, more than 4,800 linear feet of irrigation piping, along with wiring, control boxes, and irrigation heads, were installed. Construction concluded in early February. Despite challenging environmental conditions, Park Operations teams maintained the project schedule to ensure the field reopened by April 1, in time for the 2026 Little League season.

Key benefits of the new irrigation system include targeted water delivery improves efficiency and delivers significant water use savings, improved field conditions with fewer dry spots and reduced water pooling, remote system control capability enables additional operational and water savings, simplified maintenance and troubleshooting, reducing labour and response time, and enhanced safety, playability, consistency, and overall field quality.

Upcoming Sports Field Projects include renovations to the East ball field at China Creek North, the enclosed girls' softball diamond at Trafalgar Park, and both North little league fields at Nanaimo Park.

Inclusive Playground Design – Public Engagement Launch

The Inclusive Playground Design Project advances Board direction to improve accessibility and inclusion in Vancouver's parks. The project includes the City's first Inclusive Destination Playground at Memorial South Park in the Sunset neighbourhood, as well as the development of Inclusive Playground Design Guidelines to support future playground renewals city wide. Memorial South Park was recommended as the first of the five destination play areas based on its accessibility, transit access, existing park amenities, and location within an equity initiative zone.

Public engagement will take place from May 5 to May 26, focusing on inclusive play principles and early outreach to key interest holders and community partners. Engagement will include a Shape Your City webpage and online survey, targeted outreach to inclusivity organizations, and an on site presence during the Memorial South Park Centennial event, hosted by South Vancouver Neighbourhood House, on May 24 from 11:00 a.m. to 1:00 p.m. Feedback from this engagement will inform the development of the Memorial South concept design and draft Inclusive Play Design Guidelines, which will be shared with the public through a second round of engagement anticipated for Q4 2026, prior to returning to the Board for review and decision in 2027.

Special Events at Community Centres

Vancouver's Community Centre Associations deliver a wide range of special events throughout the year, celebrating holidays, culture, music, and community connection. These events are typically offered at little to no cost, ensuring that families have access to inclusive, engaging activities within their neighbourhoods.

Over the recent Easter weekend, community centres across Vancouver hosted a variety of activities, including egg hunts, games, crafts, bouncy castles, and face painting. This year alone, more than 2,050 children participated in egg hunts citywide.

Other annual events like Breakfast with Santa welcomed over 4,100 families, while during Halloween, approximately 3,000 children had a safe space to trick-or-treat and enjoy themed activities such as parties and haunted houses. Celebrations for Lunar New Year, Diwali, and Family Day also attract thousands of participants annually, reflecting the diverse and vibrant communities these centres serve.

Community Centre Associations also offer centre specific events such as outdoor movie nights, music in the park, community festivals, Mother's Day celebrations, and summer kick-off events. The continued success of these events is made possible through the dedication of the Associations and volunteers, Youth Council members, and the ongoing support of Park Board staff. Their collective efforts are integral to delivering welcoming, accessible, and high-quality experiences that foster connection and community well-being across Vancouver.

Community Youth Development 2025 Highlights

Community Centre Associations (CCAs) and Park Board continue to work collaboratively together to provide engagement opportunities for youth across the city. CCAs provide programmatic direction, support, and funding at the local level. Citywide, Park Board provides the Community Youth Development Coordinator role, and 19 Community Youth Worker positions who oversee the delivery of programs and services, and partner with other youth serving agencies to strengthen a broader system of youth supports.

In 2025, CCAs delivered over 12,000 hours of open gym time and nearly 19,000 hours in games rooms, creating safe and welcoming spaces where youth can stay active, build relationships, and feel connected to their community. Youth also contributed nearly 16,000 volunteer hours, demonstrating strong leadership, commitment, and a willingness to give back to their communities.

Additional 2025 highlights include:

- the Youth Awards held at the Roundhouse Arts, Culture and Community Centre, where over 20 youth were recognized for leadership, resilience, and achievement;
- Camp Sasamat, which provided more than 80 youth with overnight outdoor experiences, many for the first time;
- City-Wide Youth Council, which continues to build civic engagement and leadership skills, including organizing a large-scale clothing drive that filled a five-ton truck for the Hastings Project.

- Through the Building Safer Communities Program, \$100,000 in federal funding was secured in year two of a three-year grant to expand youth programming, supporting upstream violence prevention through initiatives such as guest speakers, training opportunities, enhanced youth spaces, and accessible recreation and wellness supports.

Next month's GM's report will feature highlights from Youth Week 2026 which is set to occur May 1 to 7, 2026. Commissioners will receive an invitation to the opening Youth Week event soon.

Board Briefing Memos and Emails: April 13 to April 27

Date	Topic
April 17	Stanley Park Mobility Study – Permanent Separated Bike Lane
April 24	Kitsilano Outdoor Pool - Status Update